# Questions to Ask the Doctor, the Nurse and the Discharge Planner About Mom's Care

Fifteen questions, sorted by who can answer them, with room to write what they say.

You'll get a few minutes with each person. Bring the questions written down, ask them as they are, and write the answer under each one.

This guide doesn't answer the questions and doesn't say which matters most. That depends on Mom, and the people below are the ones who know her situation.

## The discharge planner or social worker

The person arranging what happens after the hospital. It may be a social worker, a nurse or another member of staff.

1. Which daily activities do you expect Mom to need help with at home in the first weeks?

2. Which services have been arranged, who provides them, and when do they start?

3. Was any equipment recommended, and who is arranging it?

4. Can we have the discharge instructions and a summary of her current health in writing?

5. Who do we call with questions once she is home, including nights and weekends?

## The doctor

1. What should we watch for at home, and what should we do if we see it?

2. Here are the things we've noticed. Which of them do you want to look at?

3. What do you still need to find out before you can say how much help she needs?

4. When is the follow-up appointment, and what should we bring to it?

## The nurse

1. What does Mom do for herself here, and what does the staff help her with?

2. Which care tasks will we be doing at home, and can someone show us how before she leaves?

3. Is there anything about eating, swallowing, continence or skin we should keep an eye on and report?

## The pharmacist or the prescriber

1. Which medications changed during the stay, which should she keep taking, and who do we ask before changing anything?

## The therapist, if one is involved

1. How does she move between bed, chair and toilet right now, and what should we do, or not do, to help?

## A care consultant

Someone who meets Mom as well as talking with the family, and looks at the whole picture.

1. Given what we've written down so far, what else would you want to know before the next decision?

**What this guide doesn't do**

It doesn't answer these questions or tell you which one is urgent. If something seems urgent to you, say so to the person in front of you.

## Ready for the next step?

You have your questions, and soon some answers. The care interview walks you through Mom's situation area by area, so the answers have somewhere to go, and turns them into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

**Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›**

### WHERE THIS COMES FROM

Several of these questions follow the ones Medicare's discharge checklist and the Family Caregiver Alliance's guide tell families to ask. The grouping by role is ours.


1. Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services, Your Discharge Planning Checklist (CMS Product No. 11376)
2. Family Caregiver Alliance, Hospital Discharge Planning: A Guide for Families and Caregivers


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From the Family Care Roadmap · Richard Ladson, Certified Medicaid Planner. Draft for review, generated 2026-10-04.